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SECTION 1 · CASE 1

ORDINARY THEFT

A wallet, taken on a crowded street · Present day

On a crowded street, a hand slips into a pocket and leaves with a wallet. The owner notices only later. A complaint is filed, and if the pickpocket is caught, the law takes its course. Cash, cards and jewellery are taken the same way.

In India, that law is Section 303 of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023. It defines theft as dishonestly taking someone's movable property out of their possession, without consent. The pickpocket's act fits every part of that definition.

Owner, loss, law: all three are present, and the thief is obvious. Note the word *movable*. Under this section, land cannot be stolen at all — a limit Section 3 of this exhibition returns to.

OWNER ✓ LOSS ✓ LAW ✓ → **Thief: obvious**